resolution passed by UNSC to depose Syrian President Bashar Assad saw Russia and China veto the resolution, while South Africa and India abstained. The Sanya summit's declaration (held in China in 2011) says that:

> The Signees are deeply concerned with the turbulence in the Middle East and the North African regions, and sincerely wish that the states affected achieve peace, stability, prosperity, and progress, and enjoy their due standing and dignity in the world, according to legitimate aspirations of their respective country's people. (Sanya Summit Declaration 2011b)

Likewise, the New Delhi 2012 Summit revolved around security aspects itself. The Summit theme was 'BRICS Partnership for Global Stability, Security and Prosperity,' dealing with the Iranian nuclear program, Afghanistan, and the Syrian turmoil. The Summit's final declaration recognized the extreme importance of preserving stability, peace, and security in the Middle East and North Africa (Ministry of External Affairs, Government of India 2012). The BRICS group advanced its security cooperation in the Durban summit too. The declaration rejected further militarization of the Syrian conflict. The group countries are not only on the forum of BRICS; they have furthered their cooperation on other platforms (5th BRICS Summit Declaration 2013). During the G-20 Summit in 2013, St. Petersburg came out unanimously against a new war in the Middle East. The then Prime Minister of India, Manmohan Singh, was categorically against any military action while the Brazilian President took a firm stand. South African president Jacob Zuma expressed concern mentioning that small states feel increasingly vulnerable and insecure in the modern world. He also indirectly stated that more rich and powerful countries might use force against them at their discretion. At the end of the Summit, Putin said that power against a sovereign state must be used only in self-defense (Deich 2013).

Vladimir Davydov (2011), director of the Russian Academy of the Sciences, Institute of Latin America, said that the recent trends in world politics signaled that specific forces were indeed working hard to suppress the BRICS group and Russia's objectives. Likewise, Georgy Toloraya (2014), executive director of the Russian National Committee on BRICS' research, also stressed that, unfortunately, the stability in world politics had